

What the Garment Manufacturing ERP Does

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This is a system built for garment and apparel export businesses to run their whole order lifecycle in one place - from the moment a buyer sends an inquiry, through costing and production on the factory floor, to packing, shipping paperwork, and getting paid.

Masters — every reference list the system runs on

Before any order can be created, the basic building blocks need to exist in the system. These are the "masters" — reference data that gets reused everywhere else.

Categories are the top-level grouping for what you make — right now the system has "tshirt" and "kurta for women". Every buyer, order format, style and product gets tagged to one or more categories, so filtering and reporting can be done by category later.

Order Formats decide how an order's line items look on screen when someone books an order. The "Standard Format" is one row per item with the six common size units. A category can also get its own custom format — "kurta for women" is set up to allow multiple colours per item, since that's how buyers actually order that category.

Buyers hold the customer master — company name, country, agent, which categories they buy, and their outstanding balance. Two buyers are set up today: Guru Traders (Guwahati, India) and Rishabh Garment.

Style Master & Tech Pack is where an actual garment style is defined — buyer style number, factory style number, fabric and GSM, and a size-wise target batch quantity (for example, one style is booked S: 3000 / M: 3000 / L: 2000 / XL: 1000 / XXL: 1000 pieces). Each style carries its own comment thread, its BOM, and a live list of every production order raised against it, so anyone opening a style can see exactly where it stands — approved cost per piece, ready finished-goods stock, and the progress of every batch currently running on the floor.

BOM & Consumption is the fabric/trim requirement sheet per style, and it doubles as a shortfall calculator: pick a style, type in the order quantity, and it multiplies per-piece consumption by that quantity, checks what's already sitting in stock, and tells you exactly how much new material to buy. Nothing needs to be worked out separately on a spreadsheet.

Style Costing turns the BOM into a per-piece cost — BOM quantity × rate, plus cut-make charges. A costing sheet stays as a draft (still editable) until someone approves it, and once approved it locks in as "this style costs ₹X per piece" and gets referenced everywhere the style is used, including on the Tech Pack page itself.

Item Master is the trims/fabric/accessory catalogue — item code, category, HSN code, unit of measure, current stock and GST rate for every raw material the factory buys.

Suppliers Master covers everyone the factory buys from or sends work out to. A single party can be flagged as a trading supplier (sells finished material), a jobber (does job-work — the factory supplies the material, they do the work), or both, along with their registration status, city and credit terms.

FOB Values is a short reference list of freight/FOB rate names (for example "FOB Mumbai (USD)") used when export documents and invoices work out the shipping basis.

Sales & Orders — from inquiry to a confirmed order

Every order starts life as an **Inquiry**. An inquiry moves through five stages: Draft → Price Working → Quote Sent → Confirmed → Converted to OC (or it can be marked Lost if the buyer doesn't go ahead). Each inquiry is tied to one buyer, one category and one order format, and the dashboard keeps a running count of how many inquiries sit in each stage.

Once an inquiry is confirmed, it gets converted into an **Order Confirmation (OC)** — this is the actual sales contract. An OC moves through three stages: Draft → OC Sent → Confirmed. Every confirmed OC gets a contract number in the format GT/<buyer code>/<sequence>/<financial year>, for example GT/BUY01/001/2026-27, and this same contract number then follows the order through work orders, purchase orders and export documents — so anyone can trace a shipment all the way back to the original inquiry.

Manufacturing Processes — how an order actually gets made

Once an OC is confirmed, the merchandiser raises a **Work Order** against it. This is a release gate — production planning cannot start on an order until its Work Order status is "Released" (before that it sits as Draft, or it can be put on Hold). The Work Order carries the target dispatch date, and that one date drives everything downstream.

Time & Action (T&A) takes that target date and counts backward through eight checkpoints: Fabric Inward → Cutting → Printing/Embroidery → Stitching → Finishing → QC Pass → Packing → Dispatch. Each checkpoint gets a planned date, and the system tracks

the actual date against it — if a step is still open after its planned date, or was finished later than planned, it gets flagged late (with a day count), and a WhatsApp alert can go out automatically.

Production Planning is the day-to-day shop floor tracker, and it follows a nine-stage pipeline for every order: Buyer Sales Order → Style & BOM → Work Order → Cutting → Printing/Embroidery → Stitching → Finishing → Quality Check → Packing & Dispatch. What makes this useful on the floor is that quantities are tracked size-wise at every single stage — cutting, printing, stitching, finishing, QC pass, packing and dispatch each get their own S/M/L/XL/XXL (up to 5XL) breakdown, plus a damage count at that stage. So at any moment you can see, for say a 5,578-piece order, exactly how many of each size have cleared cutting versus how many have actually been packed and dispatched, and how many pieces were damaged at which stage. Bundles can also be tracked by scanning a barcode/ticket instead of typing numbers in by hand.

QC CAPA (Corrective and Preventive Action) kicks in when a mid-production quality check fails. The system comes with a seeded defect code library so everyone logs faults the same way — codes like DF-ST-01 (broken/skipped stitch), DF-CT-01 (wrong size cut), DF-FB-01 (fabric hole/tear) and DF-FN-02 (measurement out of tolerance), grouped under Cutting, Fabric, Stitching, Finishing and Other. Failing a QC check against a defect code opens a CAPA row with a fix plan and a due date, and it stays open until someone closes it.

Line Efficiency tracks daily output per sewing line against that line's target — right now there are three lines (Line 1 and Line 2 targeting 500 pieces a day, Line 3 targeting 400). Efficiency is simply pieces produced divided by target, and it can be logged from a desk screen or straight from the floor.

Phone Scan is a lightweight mobile page — it can even be installed on a phone like an app, via "Add to Home Screen" — built for the sewing line itself, with no computer needed there. An operator picks their line, scans the bundle ticket with the phone camera (or types the order number), enters how many pieces, and it logs straight into that line's stitching count.

Inventory & Job Work — stock, godowns and outside work

Fabric & Accessory Stock shows on-hand quantity for every item that appears on a style's BOM, tracked by godown and by lot/roll once goods are received. When an item's stock drops to or below its reorder level, the system flags it and can auto-create a draft

purchase order for it (grouped supplier-wise) — someone just needs to confirm the quantity and rate before it goes out. Finished-garment stock is tracked separately too, and it fills in automatically once cartons are recorded on an export document.

Godowns are the physical stores — right now there's a Finished Goods godown and a Main Fabric Godown, and every stock lot sits in one of these.

Purchase Orders raised against suppliers move through Draft → Raised → Partial → Fully Received, and each PO stays linked back to the OC it's being bought for.

Goods Inward is where material physically arriving at the factory gets logged against its PO — received quantity, passed quantity and rejected quantity are all recorded separately, and a receipt sits as "Pending Inspection" until quality checks it and marks it Approved or Rejected.

Job Work Issue/Receive handles material sent out to a jobber for outside work (like the stitching unit in Tirupur). An "Issue" records what was sent out; a "Receive" records what came back, including how many pieces came back damaged. Outstanding for any jobber is simply issued minus received, and any damage recorded on a Receive automatically becomes payable that flows straight into a Debit Note.

Packing, Shipment & Billing — getting the order out the door and paid for

Packing & Cartons is where a shipment gets packed carton by carton — how many cartons, net and gross weight — and from there the system generates the actual Packing List documents.

Export Documents is the single record for a shipment, from the moment it's raised off a confirmed OC. It's built around a 37-item checklist covering everything a shipment needs before the file can be closed — CHA-received documents, E-Sanchit documents, Assessed Copy, LEO Copy, Bill of Lading, Insurance Certificate, Swift payment copy, bank proof, FIRC, Bank Certificate, and finally the eBRC (downloaded from the RBI website), which is what actually closes the shipment file. Separately, a Generate Documents tab produces the paperwork itself: three versions of the Packing List (one for internal records with supplier names, one without supplier names for the carton, one for customs), an Item Summary, the Export Invoice (which adjusts automatically for FOB, CIF or CNF terms — for CIF it factors in insurance and freight by volume, weight or item value), the E-Invoice, carton-wise Purchase Bills, a Delivery Challan for the docks, VGM (verified gross mass) declarations, a draft Bill of Lading for the shipping line, and the bank/buyer document sets

(GR Waiver or Bill of Exchange, whichever route is used for that shipment). The invoice pulls buyer, items, prices and references straight from the sales order, so nothing needs to be retyped. There's also a GST e-invoice IRN field on each export document, and everything can be posted to Tally as XML straight from this same screen.

Purchase Bills (E-Sanchit) is the finance-side view of the same purchase-bill documents generated off export documents, for quick tracking and file access without digging into each individual shipment.

Debit Notes get raised automatically from job-work damage — quantity times rate, taken straight off the Job Work receive voucher — and the same screen flags any purchase order sitting Partial or with a shortfall, so accounts remembers to check it.

Tally integration works two ways: "Download XML" always works and can be imported into Tally manually on the accounts PC; "Post to Tally" only works if it's pointed at a machine on the same network where Tally is actually open with XML enabled (it can't post straight to Tally from the live web server) — and ledger names used have to already exist in that Tally company file.

WhatsApp alerts cover two things: a purchase order notice to a supplier, and a late Time & Action alert to a buyer. By default it just opens WhatsApp with the message pre-filled, ready to send manually; there's an optional Cloud API mode for sending automatically without anyone opening a chat window, though WhatsApp's own rules mean a template message is needed if that contact hasn't messaged in the last 24 hours.

Intelligent OCR & Reports — catching mismatches and pulling numbers out

Document OCR uses Gemini to read uploaded shipment documents (invoices, Bills of Lading, and the rest of the checklist uploads) and automatically checks the extracted details against what's actually on the ERP's sales order for that shipment — buyer name, style number, order quantity and amount. If something doesn't line up, it gets flagged straight away. For example, one check against Order PO-2026-8841 (ABC Fashion Ltd, Style ST-9042, 10,000 pcs, \$85,000) picked up that the uploaded invoice showed 10,500 pieces instead of 10,000 — buyer name, style and amount all matched, only the quantity didn't, and it was caught before anyone signed off on it by hand.

Reports gives two ways to get data out. There are ready CSV report packs built specifically for Power BI or Excel — Open Purchase Orders, Exports & Shipments, CAPA & Quality Holds, plus extra packs for the factory board, low stock, Time & Action and profit

— each one formatted so it can be dropped straight into a Power BI refresh without reshaping. And there are standard reports built into the ERP itself: a factory board (style, work order, cutting, stitching, packing, dispatch all in one view), a Supplier & Buyer Outstanding ledger, and a profit-per-order report comparing planned cost against actual.

Who can do what — roles in the system

Access is controlled by nine roles, and each one is scoped to only what that person actually needs to touch:

- **Super Admin** — full access to everything, including who gets what permissions. This is the only role that can't be edited or renamed.
- **Admin** — full day-to-day operational access, but can't change anyone's permissions.
- **Merchandising & Manufacturing** — handles everything from inquiry through to purchase orders, plus suppliers and products.
- **Accounts** — bills, payments, commission and outstanding balances.
- **Export Documentation & Foreign Payment** — shipments, export documents and getting buyer payments realised.
- **Packing** — packing lists, cartons and shipping marks.
- **Quality Checker** — inspects goods coming in and records pass/reject quantities.
- **Jobworker** — for outside jobbers logging into the system; they only ever see their own purchase orders and deliveries, nothing else in the factory's data.
- **Store keeper** — stock and godown handling.

The system roles are fixed by name (a few pages of code refer to them directly), but what each one is actually allowed to do can still be changed — only Super Admin's access is permanently locked to everything.